

Chapter 150_2 - The Eve

After the people turned into black mist and left, Jiuying suddenly stretched her limbs to relax her muscles and bones. Ning Fuyi looked at her questioningly, but saw the woman sway her waist and smile: "Don't mind me, just putting on a show for you."

So half an hour later, Ning Fuyi was pulling a two-zhang¹ tall qilin, standing with a stern face at Wuchang Cave.

Although Wuchang Cave was called a cave, it wasn't actually a cavern but a tall slope made of massive stacked rocks. This place had the highest terrain, as if one could touch the crimson sky by raising a hand. It had always been used by the demon race for life-and-death battles, so dried bloodstains were hidden in the rock crevices.

The heavy smell of blood couldn't be blown away by the wind, giving a strong stimulus to the nostrils.

Xi Que and Han Ya stood behind her, equally expressionless, overlooking the demon leaders in front who looked confused and exchanged glances.

"Go help those damn immortal sects fight Penglai!?" A demon with a loud voice spoke up. He had a bull's head, horse face, and human body, holding a trident. "The immortal realm is killing each other—why should we demons join this chaos?"

"Exactly! The immortal realm has oppressed us for ten thousand years. Now is a rare opportunity to destroy the immortal realm. Instead of waiting to reap the benefits, why are we getting involved? Are we waiting to be exterminated by the immortal sects!" Another person in black robes shouted, causing the rest to also voice complaints.

Ning Fuyi didn't speak, but Jiuying beside her suddenly roared toward the sky. The beast's roar stirred up dust from the ground, and amid the scorching flames, it frightened the demon leaders into quickly shutting their mouths.

"Shangchou." Ning Fuyi didn't say much to them but called out. Black mist arose, and the armored Shangchou appeared in the thick fog, casually throwing the bag he was carrying on the ground.

Sounds of shock immediately arose. The demon leaders couldn't help but step back, unconsciously touching their own necks.

The bag contained the heads of demon race members who had come to provoke but were defeated. Now the dried heads rolled all over the ground—the pressure was enough that no one dared say another word.

These were all self-proclaimed kings, leaders big and small with their own pride. Only by first using their lives to suppress them could they be made to quiet down and listen.

Seeing that no one dared to speak anymore, Ning Fuyi finally made a sound.

"Reap the benefits? How do you know Penglai and the immortal sects will mutually destroy each other? If the immortal sects win, that's fine, but if they lose and the mountains and rivers are destroyed, do you think the demon race can be spared?" Ning Fuyi's voice was mellow and clear, circling between heaven and earth with echoing reverberations.

"Emperor Tianrui has cultivated for ten thousand years, and all of Penglai are demigods with unfathomable power. If we stand by and watch Penglai defeat the immortal sects, then it won't just be the immortal and mortal realms that suffer—the entire six realms will be destroyed in one fell swoop."

"Penglai's goal isn't just the immortal realm, but to make all six realms submit. Or worse, they've long planned for world destruction. Otherwise, why would they release the Wuji ghost fire, why would they destroy the Eastern Wasteland's Konghou², stirring the six realms into chaos?" Ning Fuyi said with a thunderous voice.

"All things in the world—immortals, demons, monsters, ghosts, rivers, mountains, grass, and trees—all depend on heaven and earth to live. Penglai's goal is very likely to return heaven and earth to chaos. Do you think you can escape this calamity then?"

The demons and monsters below the slope all fell silent upon hearing this, exchanging glances.

"But those immortal sects have always treated us as inferior. The moment we show ourselves, they shout to kill us. I, Old Bull, have suffered so much at the hands of immortal sects. Now to shamelessly help the immortal sects that oppress us—where do we put our dignity?" The bull-headed man threw down his trident, his massive body sitting down with a grumble.

"Old Bull makes sense." A person with one leg half-shortened, wrapped in bloodstained cloth strips all over his body with only one eye showing, spoke in a muffled voice. "The immortal sects slaughtered all my subordinate demons. If I help the immortal sects, how can I face their spirits in heaven?"

"Since you don't want to live, this lord will help you right now." Ning Fuyi raised her hand as she spoke, and the Emei Thorn obediently began spinning circles in her palm.

At the same time, thunder crashed several times in the sky, shaking all the demons into covering their heads and hiding.

The bull-headed man quickly scrambled up, grinning widely to placate: "Demon Lord, it's not that we don't understand the bigger picture, but if we help the immortal sects and they later turn ungrateful and slaughter us again, wouldn't it be better to die now and at least preserve this old dignity?"

"After all, the immortal sects see us as floods and fierce beasts. I've never killed a single mortal since I was born, but the first time I left the demon realm, I was chased and beaten by several immortal sect kids, scaring me into a mess!"

The one who responded looked no different from mortals, except he had a yin-yang face and hair that grew like seaweed, floating oily and smooth in the sky like kite strings.

"I'm called Charming Woman," the yin-yang face said coquettishly.

Ning Fuyi's gaze lingered on her towering hair for a moment before forcibly moving away, returning to the bull-headed man.

"The grudges between immortals and demons indeed have deep origins. The immortal race considers the demon race evil and has always been hostile, while the demon race has indeed repeatedly produced those who bring disaster to the world, making these grudges even deeper." Ning Fuyi said.

"Those immortals also have fallen gods and fallen immortals, but we've never seen them relentlessly pursue their own kind. Why do they only target us demons and monsters? Most of us in the demon realm don't even dare leave the demon realm, fearing they'll kill us to make pills." Charming Woman said dissatisfiedly.

"Exactly! When Demon Lord Jun Molan was alive, though immortals and demons often clashed, at least we weren't bullied. But once Jun Molan died, our demon race could only be slaughtered at will, hiding in this demon realm daily fighting over territory and magic stones. Especially when my magic power was weak, anyone could step on me!" Half-leg wiped bloody tears.

The bull-headed man tugged at him a few times, and only then did he remember something, glancing at the scattered heads on the ground and falling silent in terror.

Ning Fuyi opened her mouth, swallowing the words she wanted to say.

Being an immortal, she unconsciously thought from the immortal realm's standpoint, which led to those earlier words. But if she put herself in the position of these demon race members—born into the demon realm's chaos, born to struggle for life on the knife's edge—how could they learn the same benevolence as immortals?

The demon realm wasn't like this ten thousand years ago. At that time, there was a Demon Lord governing. Though they often clashed with the immortal realm, the conflicts mostly stemmed from the ancient concepts of both races, not any deep hatred.

Ning Fuyi, you proclaimed yourself Demon Lord, but besides using the demon race as a refuge and saving some who came to you, and killing some cruel and bloodthirsty tumors, what have you done for the demon race? What have you done for the peace of both races? Ning Fuyi suddenly began questioning herself.

Seeing Ning Fuyi fall silent, the demons standing on the slope began looking at each other again. Then Charming Woman's hair reached over from mid-air, poking Ning Fuyi's shoulder.

Ning Fuyi almost jumped from being poked by her hair and quickly stepped back to avoid it.

"Demon Lord, what are you thinking about?" Charming Woman stretched her neck and asked.

Ning Fuyi shook her head. She suddenly raised her hand and collected all the scattered heads from the ground, so the bloody smell also dissipated somewhat, making the air on the slope much more pleasant.

"I'm reflecting on how I never truly helped you." She said truthfully.

Upon hearing this, one of the demon leaders' eyes grew wider and wider. As they widened, his two eyeballs plopped to the ground with a sound. Someone nearby quickly bent down to help him pick them up and stuffed them back in.

Silence fell over the slope.

"This time I've summoned you all not to use you, but to persuade you to protect yourselves. As for why it's self-protection, I've already explained clearly and won't repeat it." Ning Fuyi said gently.

"I know the immortal realm has many prejudices against the demon realm. These prejudices arise from the differences between our two races and have been intensified through tens of thousands of years of confrontation, so mutual hostility between the two races is inevitable. Now the demon race has declined with no one to lead, which is why chaos abounds and internal strife continues."

"The result of continuing this way is that even without Penglai's world destruction, the demon race will eventually perish—either dying from racial extinction or being slaughtered by the immortal realm." Ning Fuyi's words struck like hammers, making everyone frown. The atmosphere was like a lake after frost—cold and silent.

"Since I took Jun Molan's Emei Thorn and occupied the Demon Cave to proclaim myself Demon Lord, I cannot be indifferent to demon race lives. After this great calamity passes, I will replace Jun Molan in revitalizing the demon race, making the immortal realm stop oppressing the demon race, and achieving peace among the six realms."

Upon hearing this, the demon leaders became even more restless. Some whispered to each other, others trembled with fear, wanting to say something but afraid.

"But the immortal realm has hated the demon race for so long. How can they change their minds so quickly?" Charming Woman said quietly.

"I'm not asking the immortal realm to change their minds. It's better to rely on oneself than others. Peaceful coexistence between the two races depends on nothing more than two things: bound interests or equal strength. As long as the demon realm is strong enough to resist the immortal realm, achieving peace would be easy!" Ning Fuyi smiled.

No one wanted to hide like rats crossing the street. Her words went unchallenged, clearly speaking to their hearts.

"Moreover, when I say I'll lead you to fight Penglai, I'll naturally expose myself to everyone in the immortal realm, completely marking myself as a demon. From then on, I'll only be a member of the demon race and can never return to the immortal realm." Ning Fuyi continued. "Since you and I share the same fate, you needn't fear I'll go back on my word."

The demons before her whispered to each other, nodding frequently.

Most demon race members were physically strong, violent, and bloodthirsty, but simple-minded. Seeing them nod, Ning Fuyi knew her words had been accepted and breathed a sigh of relief.

After a while, the bull-headed man raised his trident and asked expectantly: "After leaving this demon realm, can I eat a few bites of mortal grass?"

Ning Fuyi almost laughed out loud. She looked up at Jiuying, then nodded.

"Yes," she promised.

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Time passed, and only one night remained until the agreed day to attack Penglai. Chu Qingqiu had been standing on the cliff since dusk, gazing at the sky's edge waiting.

The wind lifted her robes, like a crane with feathers flying in the night.

"Divine Venerable." Liu Wenzhu ran from Cloud Deep Hall to her side, looked toward the horizon with her, then said: "All sects except Feihua Sect are ready. Tomorrow we'll first gather at Zhaoyao Mountain, then go to Penglai together."

"Also, Divine Doctor Jiang has gone with his family, saying he wants to use medical skills to help everyone."

"Good." Chu Qingqiu nodded, but she gripped the white bone with both hands, quite restless.

"Divine Venerable, are you waiting for Ning Fuyi? Where did Yiyi go?" Liu Wenzhu probed.

"She..." Chu Qingqiu paused, still not speaking. "She has business."

"I want to wait for her to return." Chu Qingqiu lowered her eyelids.

Footnotes:

1. **Zhang (丈)** - A traditional Chinese unit of measurement, approximately 3.3 meters or 10.8 feet
2. **Konghou (箜篌)** - An ancient Chinese harp-like musical instrument, here referring to a specific location in the Eastern Wasteland